

Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος

Heraclitus of Ephesus and the Homeric Allegories

eul_aid: bko

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Presocratic](#)

Heraclitus of Ephesus was a Greek philosopher active around 500 BCE. A member of an aristocratic family in the Ionian city of Ephesus, he was later given the nicknames "the Obscure" and "the Riddler" due to the paradoxical and enigmatic style of his writing.

He is credited with a single book, often referred to by later authors as **On Nature**. The original work does not survive. Modern knowledge of his thought comes from approximately 130 short, aphoristic fragments preserved in the writings of later philosophers and Christian authors.

Heraclitus is a foundational figure in early Greek philosophy. His central concept is the Logos, an underlying principle of order that governs the cosmos. He is most famous for the doctrine of universal flux, often summarized by the sayings "everything flows" and "you cannot step into the same river twice." According to modern scholars, he viewed the cosmos as an ever-living fire undergoing constant transformation, and he emphasized the unity of opposites. His obscure style and profound ideas significantly influenced later thinkers, including Plato and the Stoics.

Works (1)

- Ἀλληγορίαι ἢ Ὀμηρικαὶ Ζητήσεις · [Allegories Or Homeric Questions](#) · 307 passages

Other Presocratic Authors

- Ἀλκμαίων ὁ Κροτωνιάτης · [Alcmaeon of Croton](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξαγόρας ὁ Κλαζομένιος · [Anaxagoras of Clazomenae](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξίμανδρος ὁ Μιλήσιος · [Anaximander of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξίμενης ὁ Μιλήσιος · [Anaximenes of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Ἀναξίμενους τοῦ Μιλήσιου Ἐπιστολαί (Ψευδο-Ἀναξίμενης) · [Anaximenes-pseudo Miletus Letters](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρχέλαος ὁ Μιλήσιος ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · [Archelaus of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- Κλεόβουλος ὁ Λίνδιος · [Cleobulus of Lindos I](#) · 1 work
- Δημόκριτος ὁ Ἀβδηρίτης · [Democritus of Abdera](#) · 2 works
- Διογένης ὁ Ἀπολλωνιάτης · [Diogenes of Apollonia](#) · 2 works
- Ἐμπεδοκλῆς ὁ Ἀκραγαντίνος · [Empedocles of Acragas](#) · 3 works
- Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · [Heraclitus of Ephesus](#) · 2 works

- Ἑρμόδωρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · *Hermodorus of Ephesus* · 2 works